

TECHNICAL REPORT WRITING (TRW) (Basics)

CHAPTER NO 1

DEFINITION OF TECHNICAL WRITING

DEFINITION

“Technical writing aims to get work done, to change people by changing the way they do things”

(Killingsworth and Gilbertson)

THE THREE FUNDAMENTAL IDEAS

The goal of the course is to make you effective and confident technical writers; and to be effective you need to know and fully understand the following three main, most important and fundamental ideas. All the rest of the ideas stem from these three ideas.

1. Technical writing is '**Audience Centered**'
2. Technical writing is '**Presentational**'
3. Technical writing is '**Responsible**'

Technical writing is 'Audience Centered'

- It deals with specific situations
- It enables readers to act
- It occurs within a community
- It is interactive
- It has definite purposes

Technical writing is 'Presentational'

- Use the top-down method
- Use headings
- Use Chunks
- Use visual aids
- Establish a consistent visual logic
- Use plain and objective language

Technical writing is 'Presentational'

- Use honest language
- Use format honestly
- Create helpful visuals
- Use direct and simple expression
- Credit others
- Code of ethical conduct